

Proposal for Emoji: Stomach

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Date: 2026-07-12

Identification

Suggested name: Stomach

Suggested keywords: digestion; gut; belly; abdomen; hunger; appetite; fullness; nausea; indigestion; reflux

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near anatomical heart, lungs, and brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The paradigm uses the stomach's curved hollow-organ body with a visible inlet and outlet. These cues distinguish it from food, a generic blob, or another solid organ. Vendors may simplify the inlet and outlet if the characteristic curved silhouette remains recognizable.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Stomach has established emotional and figurative meanings in addition to anatomy and digestion. Familiar expressions include butterflies in the stomach, a nervous stomach, an empty or strong stomach, being unable to stomach something, and following a gut feeling. These meanings support emotion, appetite, tolerance, intuition, and physical sensation without depending on a pun.

B. Use in sequences

Stomach can combine with existing emoji to create messages without standardized sequences:

- Stomach + fork and knife: hunger, meals, appetite, digestion, or fullness.
- Stomach + nauseated face: nausea, stomach bug, or upset stomach.
- Stomach + warning: stomach pain, food reaction, or urgent symptom.
- Stomach + pill or hospital: antacid, treatment, endoscopy, or digestive care.
- Stomach + butterfly: nervous anticipation or butterflies in the stomach.
- Stomach + brain or thought bubble: gut feeling or intuition.

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. No current emoji represents the stomach or digestion as an organ process. Food emoji show what is eaten; nauseated face shows a feeling; and hospital, pill, and syringe show care or treatment. None identifies the stomach itself. The proposal therefore adds a distinct digestive-organ concept with ordinary uses in food, sensation, emotion, education, and health.

D. Distinctiveness

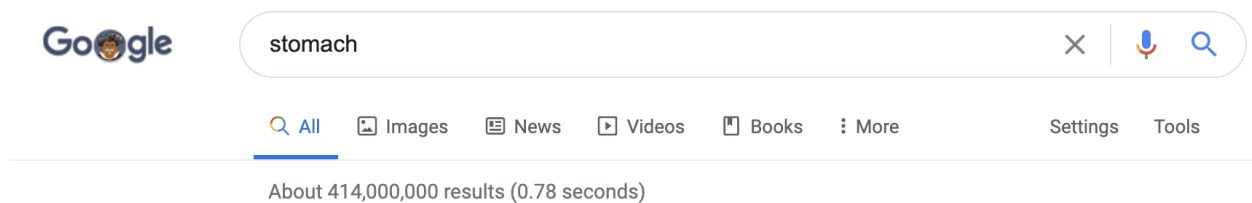
The stomach's asymmetrical curved form, narrow inlet, rounded body, and outlet are recognizable in school diagrams and public health illustration. The example remains distinguishable in black and white and at 18x18 because recognition rests on silhouette rather than color or fine internal texture. It does not resemble anatomical heart, lungs, or brain.

E. Expected usage level

Stomach is used in everyday conversations about digestion, eating, hunger, appetite, fullness, nausea, stomach ache, indigestion, reflux, medication, endoscopy, family health, and school science. The five frequency screenshots required by Unicode are embedded below. The table records what each capture shows, its capture date, and its full reproducible URL. Google Trends and Google Books compare `stomach` with Unicode's reference term `eLephant`.

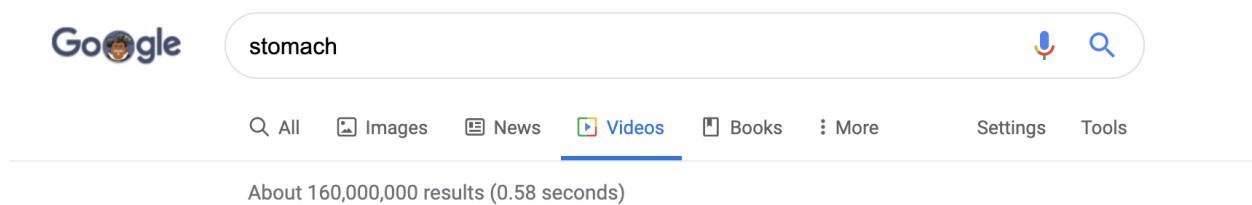
Evidence	Result in included capture	Reproducible URL
Google Search	About 414,000,000 results; captured 2020-08-31	https://www.google.com/search?q=stomach&hl=en&num=10&pws=0
Google Video Search	About 160,000,000 results; captured 2020-08-31	https://www.google.com/search?tbm=vid&q=stomach&hl=en&num=10&pws=0
Google Trends Web Search	Worldwide, 2004 through the 2020 capture date; stomach exceeds elephant in average interest and rises substantially over the captured period; captured 2020-08-31	https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&q=stomach,elephant
Google Trends Image Search	Worldwide, 2008 through the 2020 capture date; sustained stomach image-search interest; captured 2020-08-31	https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all_2008&gprop=images&q=stomach,elephant
Google Books Ngram Viewer	English, 1500-2022; stomach substantially exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage; captured 2026-07-09	https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Cstomach&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3

Google Search



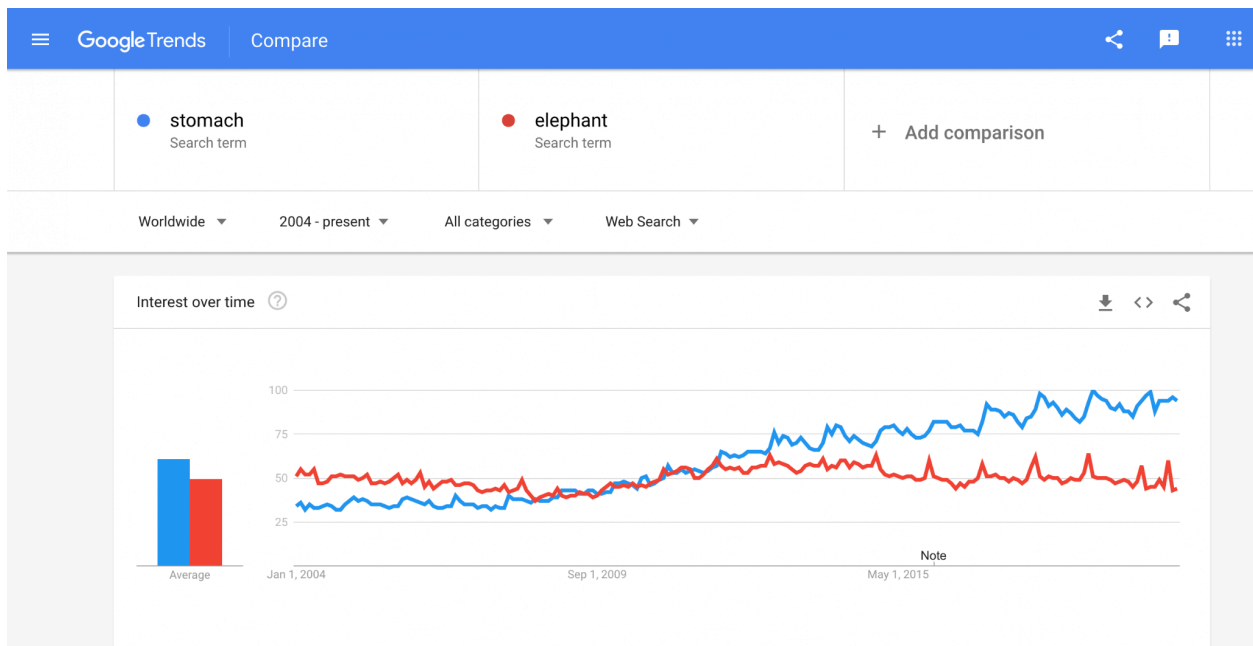
Google search interface for the query "stomach". The search bar contains the text "stomach". Below the search bar, the results are displayed as "About 414,000,000 results (0.78 seconds)". The interface includes navigation links for All, Images, News, Videos, Books, and More, as well as Settings and Tools.

Google Video Search

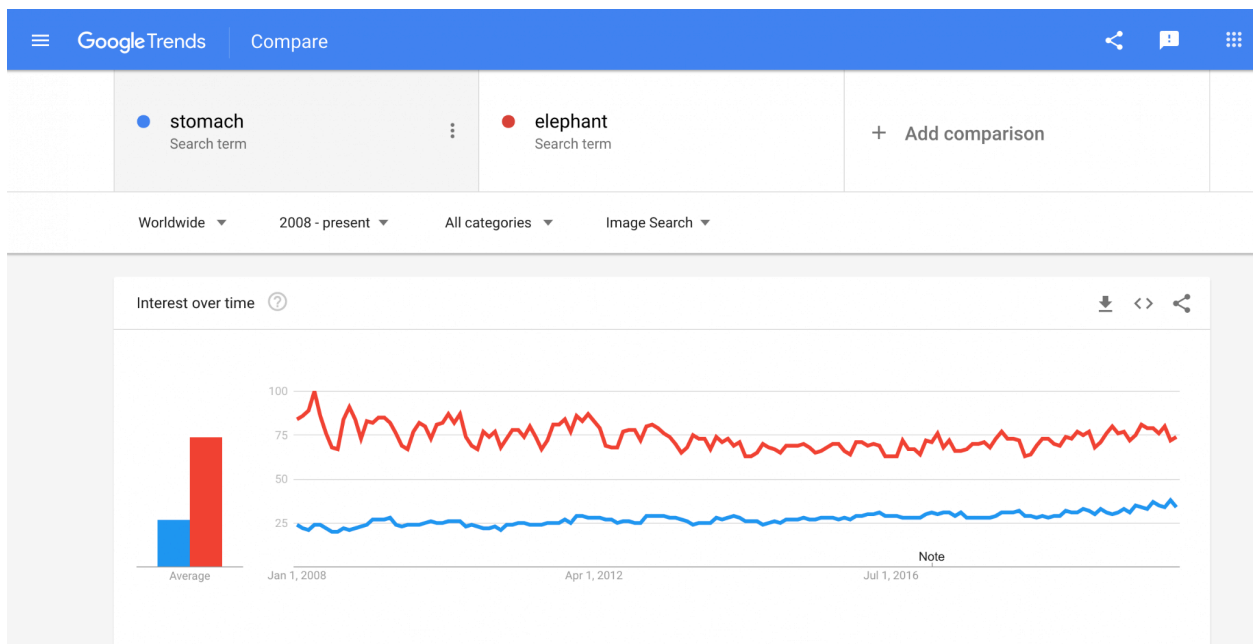


Google Video Search interface for the query "stomach". The search bar contains the text "stomach". Below the search bar, the results are displayed as "About 160,000,000 results (0.58 seconds)". The interface includes navigation links for All, Images, News, Videos, Books, and More, as well as Settings and Tools.

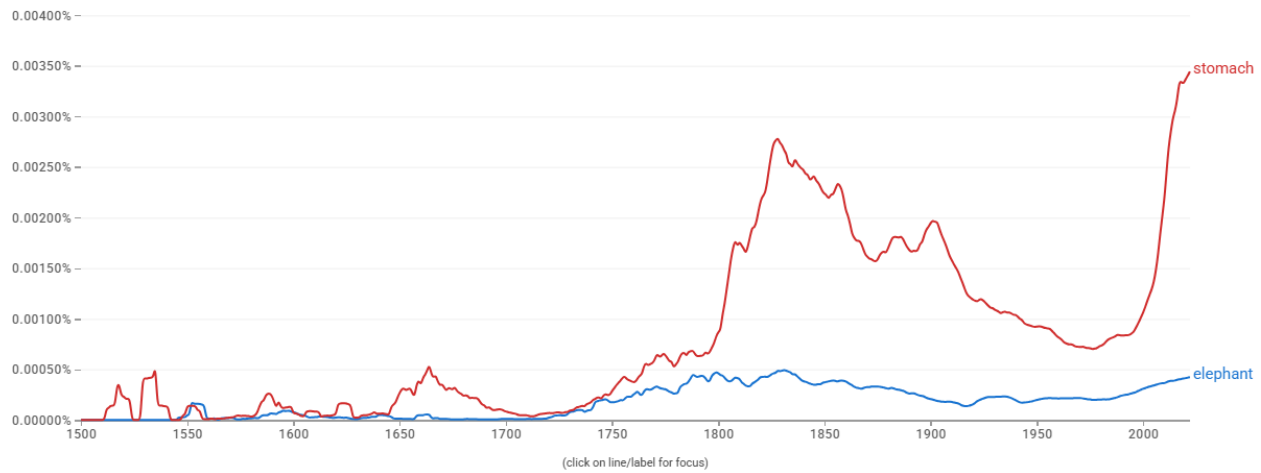
Google Trends - Web Search



Google Trends - Image Search



Google Books Ngram Viewer



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Stomach is independently useful and is not proposed merely to complete a set of organs.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or another encoded pictograph.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already representable

Stomach is not represented by an existing emoji. Food, nauseated face, hospital, and pill can imply related circumstances but cannot identify the organ, distinguish hunger from nausea, or express stomach-specific anatomy and care.

B. Overly specific

Stomach is a primary organ and an everyday concept, not a particular disease, procedure, specialty, organization, campaign, or brand. It covers digestion, hunger, fullness, symptoms, emotion, education, nutrition, and health.

C. Open-ended

This proposal does not request a complete anatomy taxonomy. Stomach is supported by its own frequency, multiple usages, visual distinctiveness, and lack of an adequate substitute. Other organs can be judged independently on the same criteria.

D. Transient

Digestion, hunger, fullness, nausea, abdominal discomfort, and stomach-related expressions are durable across generations and are not tied to a temporary event or trend.

E. Faulty comparison

The proposal does not argue that stomach should be encoded merely because other organs exist. Its case rests on its own expected usage, broad meanings, recognizable silhouette, and expressive gap.

Other Information

The singular common name `Stomach` is concise and searchable. Essential design cues are an asymmetrical curved hollow-organ body and at least a suggestion of the inlet or outlet. Fine anatomical detail is optional and should yield to legibility at 18x18. Vendors should avoid a form that reads primarily as food or a generic pink shape.

Official Unicode proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>